

# Chapter 27 — Biconsonantal / Geminate Disambiguation Drill

BBH Chapters 25 & 27 · Niphal and Hiphil Weak Verbs

For each form: (1) identify the stem (Niphal or Hiphil); (2) parse — conjugation, PGN; (3) identify the weak class (Biconsonantal or Geminate); (4) give the root and translate. Biconsonantal and Geminate forms are vocally identical — root knowledge is required. Answer key is on the last page.

Biconsonantal (II-ו/ה): medial vowel letter ו or י retained in stem (e.g. וּכְנַח, שָׁמַח, בָּרַח, בָּרַח, בָּרַח). Geminate (R2=R3): same consonant at R2 and R3; no medial vowel letter (e.g. סָבַב, מָמַח, מָמַח). Both classes share: Niphal perfect נָ (qamets); Hiphil perfect הָ (tsere); Hiphil imperfect יָ (qamets); Hiphil imperative הָ (qamets); Hiphil participle מָ (tsere).

## Part A — Niphal: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Niphal. Identify whether each is Biconsonantal (medial ו/ה) or Geminate (R2=R3). The prefix vowel pattern (נָ in perfect; יָ in imperfect) is identical for both classes.

| # | Form   | Ref        | Context                        | Stem | Conjugation | PGN | Class | Root |
|---|--------|------------|--------------------------------|------|-------------|-----|-------|------|
| 1 | נָכַח  | Gen 41:32  | "the thing is ___ by God"      |      |             |     |       |      |
| 2 | נָסַב  | 1 Kgs 7:24 | "the gourds ___ it, ten to a   |      |             |     |       |      |
| 3 | נָכַח  | Psa 93:2   | "your throne ___ from of old"  |      |             |     |       |      |
| 4 | נָסַב  | Num 21:4   | "they traveled ___ Mount Edom" |      |             |     |       |      |
| 5 | נָכַח  | Psa 57:8   | "my heart is ___, O God"       |      |             |     |       |      |
| 6 | נָסַב  | Num 34:4   | "your border ___ from the      |      |             |     |       |      |
| 7 | נָשַׁב | Lam 3:40   | "let us examine and ___ to the |      |             |     |       |      |
| 8 | נָתַח  | 1 Sam 3:12 | "when I ___ what I have        |      |             |     |       |      |

## Part B — Hiphil: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Hiphil. Hiphil prefix patterns: הָ (perfect) · יָ (imperfect) · הָ (imperative) · מָ (participle). These are identical for Biconsonantal and Geminate — root knowledge is the only distinguisher.

| #  | Form    | Ref        | Context                         | Stem | Conjugation | PGN | Class | Root |
|----|---------|------------|---------------------------------|------|-------------|-----|-------|------|
| 9  | הִקִּים | Gen 6:18   | "I will ___ my covenant with    |      |             |     |       |      |
| 10 | הִסִּב  | 2 Sam 2:22 | "___ from following me"         |      |             |     |       |      |
| 11 | הִקִּים | Deut 18:15 | "the LORD will ___ a prophet"   |      |             |     |       |      |
| 12 | הִסִּב  | Eccl 1:6   | "the wind ___ to the south"     |      |             |     |       |      |
| 13 | הִקִּים | Deut 27:26 | "___ the words of this law"     |      |             |     |       |      |
| 14 | הִסִּב  | 2 Sam 2:22 | "___ from following me"         |      |             |     |       |      |
| 15 | הִקִּים | 1 Sam 2:8  | "He ___ the poor from the dust" |      |             |     |       |      |
| 16 | הִסִּב  | Jer 21:4   | "I am turning around the        |      |             |     |       |      |

## Part C — Mixed: Stem and Class Both Unknown

Identify both the stem (Niphal/Hiphal/Qal/Hophal) and the class. Part C includes Qal and Hophal forms as distractors — not every Biconsonantal form is Niphal or Hiphil.

| #  | Form     | Ref       | Context                            | Stem | Conjugation | PGN | Class | Root |
|----|----------|-----------|------------------------------------|------|-------------|-----|-------|------|
| 17 | נִמּוֹג  | Isa 14:31 | "all Philistia ____"               |      |             |     |       |      |
| 18 | הִמָּסוּ | Deu 1:28  | "our brothers ____ our hearts"     |      |             |     |       |      |
| 19 | יָרֵם    | Isa 52:13 | "my servant shall be high and      |      |             |     |       |      |
| 20 | יָרֵם    | Psa 99:2  | "great is the LORD, ____ above     |      |             |     |       |      |
| 21 | הִרִים   | Gen 14:22 | "I have ____ my hand to the        |      |             |     |       |      |
| 22 | הוֹרָם   | Lev 4:10  | "just as it is ____ from the peace |      |             |     |       |      |
| 23 | יָשׁוּב  | Hos 14:8  | "they ____ in the shade"           |      |             |     |       |      |
| 24 | יִשֹּׁב  | Lam 1:11  | "all her people ____ to find       |      |             |     |       |      |

### Reflection Questions

- Items 1 (נִיכַח) and 2 (נִבְסַח) have the same נִ prefix. What is the only reliable way to identify נִיכַח as Biconsonantal (root נִיכַח) and נִבְסַח as Geminate (root נִבְסַח)?
- Items 9 (מִי־קָה) and 10 (מִי־סָה) both have מִ prefix (tsere). One retains a medial vowel letter; the other shows a contracted stem. Describe precisely what the medial position of each form looks like and how that reflects the root structure.
- Items 11 (מִי־קָי) and 12 (מִי־סָי) are both Hiphil imperfect 3ms. You encounter an unknown form יִלְדֵּי. What question must you ask to determine if it is Biconsonantal or Geminate?
- Items 19 (מִי־רָי) and 21 (מִי־רָה) come from the same root (מִי־רָ) but differ in stem. What vowel under R2 distinguishes the Niphal imperfect from the Hiphil perfect?
- Item 22 (מִי־רָה) was classified as Hophal. How does the Hophal Biconsonantal prefix (מִי־רָה) differ from Niphal (נִי־רָה) and Hiphil (הִי־רָה), and what does it tell you about the semantics?

### Answer Key

| #  | Form    | Stem          | Answer                                                                                                             |
|----|---------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | נָכֹן   | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect/Ptc · 3ms/ms · Biconsonantal · נִּכּוּן — "is established / firm" — נִּ prefix (qamets); medial וּ vowel   |
| 2  | נָסַב   | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · נִּבְּסָ — "encircled / went around" — נִּ prefix (qamets); R2=R3=בּ = Geminate;        |
| 3  | יִכּוֹן | <b>Niphal</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִכּוּן — "is established" — יִּ + dagesh in כּ + holem-vav = Niphal             |
| 4  | יִסַּב  | <b>Niphal</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִבְּסָ — "went around" — יִּ + dagesh in ס (R2=R3 doubled) + holem =                 |
| 5  | הִכּוֹן | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִכּוּן — "is ready / prepared" — הִּ + dagesh + holem-vav = Niphal                |
| 6  | הִסַּב  | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turned / went around" — הִּ + dagesh in ס (R2=R3) + holem = Niphal           |
| 7  | נָשׁוּב | <b>Niphal</b> | Cohortative · 1cp · Biconsonantal · נִּבּוּשׁ — "let us return" — נִּ prefix + medial וּ = Niphal Biconsonantal;   |
| 8  | נִתֵּם  | <b>Niphal</b> | Inf. Const. · — · Geminate · נִתְּמָ — "to be completed / finished" — נִּ prefix + holem = Niphal Geminate         |
| 9  | הִקִּים | <b>Hiphil</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִקִּם — "established / raised up" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; medial וּ vowel  |
| 10 | הִסִּב  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turned aside" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; no medial vowel letter,         |
| 11 | יִקִּים | <b>Hiphil</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִקִּם — "will raise up" — יִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil Biconsonantal            |
| 12 | יִסִּב  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִבְּסָ — "causes to go around / turns" — יִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil; no            |
| 13 | הִקֵּם  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Imperative · 2ms · Biconsonantal · הִקֵּם — "raise up! / confirm!" — הִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative;      |
| 14 | הִסִּב  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Imperative · 2ms · Geminate · הִבְּסָ — "turn aside!" — הִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative; same vowels       |
| 15 | מִקִּים | <b>Hiphil</b> | Participle · ms · Biconsonantal · מִקֵּם — "one who raises up" — מִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; medial וּ |
| 16 | מִסִּב  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Participle · ms · Geminate · מִבְּסָ — "turning / surrounding" — מִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; no        |
| 17 | נִמּוּג | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · נִמּוּג — "melted / dissolved" — נִּ prefix + medial וּ = Niphal Biconsonantal;    |
| 18 | הִמָּסָ | <b>Hiphil</b> | Perfect · 3cp · Geminate · הִמָּסָ — "caused to melt" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; R2=R3=ס = Geminate;           |
| 19 | יִרָם   | <b>Niphal</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרָם — "will be exalted / lifted up" — יִּ prefix + qibbutz under R2            |
| 20 | יִרֵם   | <b>Niphal</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרָם — "is exalted / high" — יִּ prefix + holem under R2 = Niphal               |
| 21 | הִרִים  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִרִם — "lifted up / swore an oath" — הִּ prefix (tsere) + chiriq-yod = Hiphil     |
| 22 | הוֹרֵם  | <b>Hophal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הוֹרָם — "was lifted off / removed" — הוּ prefix (holem-vav) = Hophal              |
| 23 | יָשׁוּב | <b>Qal</b>    | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יָבּוּשׁ — "will dwell / return" — Qal Biconsonantal — no Niphal נִ or Hiphil    |
| 24 | יָשַׁב  | <b>Qal</b>    | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יָבּוּשׁ — "returned / went around" — Qal Biconsonantal; holem vowel             |